07-Pre-Exercise-Blue-Team-Checklist

Pre-Exercise Blue Team Preparation Checklist

Complete all items as applicable before the Purple Team Exercise begins. Assign an owner and target completion date for each section.

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1. Detection Coverage Baseline

- ❑ Run DeTT&CT scoring against ATT&CK techniques and data sources for all in-scope platforms
- ❑ Export a pre-exercise ATT&CK Navigator layer showing current detection posture
- ❑ Classify each in-scope technique into one of the following categories:
  - ☐ No visibility (telemetry not collected)
  - ☐ Telemetry available (logs collected, no detection rule)
  - ☐ Detection rule deployed (automated alert in place)
  - ☐ Detection validated (rule confirmed to fire correctly on known-good test data)
- ❑ Archive the baseline Navigator layer (JSON export) in the team's version-controlled repository
- ❑ Share the baseline layer with the Exercise Coordinator and Red Team lead

Owner: _____ Target Date: _____

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2. Data Source and Log Ingestion Validation

Endpoint Telemetry

- ❑ Confirm EDR agents are active and reporting on all target endpoints
- ❑ Verify OS audit log policies are configured (Windows Security Event Log, Linux auditd, macOS Unified Logging)
- ❑ Verify PowerShell script block logging and module logging are enabled (Windows targets)
- ❑ Confirm endpoint logs are forwarding to the SIEM without gaps

Network Telemetry

- ❑ Verify DNS query logging is active and forwarding to the SIEM
- ❑ Confirm proxy/web gateway logs are being collected
- ❑ Verify NetFlow or PCAP collection is active for in-scope network segments

- ❑ Confirm TLS decryption/inspection is enabled for exercise traffic paths
- ❑ Verify firewall logs are forwarding for in-scope zones

Identity and Authentication Logs

- ❑ Confirm Active Directory/domain controller logs are forwarding (Event IDs 4624, 4625, 4648, 4672, 4688, 4720, 4732, etc.)
- ❑ Verify Identity Provider (IdP) audit logs are flowing (Azure AD/Entra ID, Okta, Ping, etc.)
- ❑ Confirm cloud IAM logs are active (AWS IAM, Azure RBAC, GCP IAM)
- ❑ Verify Privileged Access Management (PAM) logs are forwarding

Cloud Control Plane Logs (If in scope)

- ❑ Confirm AWS CloudTrail is enabled and forwarding for in-scope accounts
- ❑ Confirm Azure Activity Logs and Azure Monitor are active for in-scope subscriptions
- ❑ Confirm GCP Audit Logs are enabled for in-scope projects
- ❑ Verify cloud log ingestion latency is within acceptable thresholds (under 5 minutes)

Ingestion Health

- ❑ Check for ingestion latency across all data sources (target: under 5 minutes for critical sources)
- ❑ Check for parsing errors or field extraction failures in the SIEM
- ❑ Check for dropped events or rate-limited sources
- ❑ Cross-reference the ATT&CK data sources required for the selected TTPs against the validated data sources above
- ❑ Document any data source gaps and communicate them to the Exercise Coordinator

Owner: _____ Target Date: _____

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3. Review Existing Detection Rules Against Exercise TTPs

- ❑ Obtain the TTP list or adversary emulation plan from the Exercise Coordinator / CTI team
- ❑ For each TTP, determine whether a detection rule currently exists
- ❑ For each existing rule, record:
  - ❑ Platform the rule runs on (SIEM, EDR, NDR, cloud-native)
  - ❑ Last validation date (when was the rule last confirmed to fire on a true positive or test case?)
  - ❑ Current status (enabled, disabled, suppressed)
  - ❑ Known false positive history or tuning exceptions applied
- ❑ Flag TTPs with no detection coverage
- ❑ Flag TTPs with detection rules that have not been validated in the past 90 days
- ❑ Compile findings into a pre-exercise detection readiness summary and share with the Exercise Coordinator

Owner: _____ **Target Date:** _____

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4. Prepare Hunt Queries and Playbooks

- ❑ For each TTP without automated detection, draft an ad-hoc hunt query targeting available telemetry
- ❑ Validate that each hunt query runs successfully against the SIEM or hunting platform (no syntax errors, returns results within acceptable time)
- ❑ Reference ThreatHunter-Playbook or equivalent resources for query templates where applicable
- ❑ Document the data sources, log fields, and behavioral indicators each query relies on
- ❑ Pre-stage hunt queries in the team's hunting platform or shared query library so they are ready to execute on exercise day
- ❑ Assign a hunt team member to each TTP requiring manual hunting

Owner: _____ **Target Date:** _____

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5. Forensic Readiness

- ❑ Verify memory acquisition tools are deployed and functional on all target systems
- ❑ Verify disk imaging capabilities are available for target systems (physical and virtual)
- ❑ Confirm live forensic utilities are installed on target endpoints (per the Blue Team Preparation items in Exercise Checklist)
- ❑ Verify the DFIR case created during planning is accessible to all DFIR analysts
- ❑ Confirm all analysts know the case number and evidence tagging conventions
- ❑ Validate that chain-of-custody forms are available and the documentation procedure is understood
- ❑ Confirm evidence storage locations have sufficient capacity for exercise artifacts
- ❑ Verify target systems will not be segmented, reimaged, or wiped during the exercise window

Owner: _____ **Target Date:** _____

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6. Communication and Escalation Dry Run

- ❑ Verify all exercise communication channels are operational (Slack, Teams, video bridge, etc.)
- ❑ Confirm all Blue Team participants (SOC, Hunt, DFIR) can access the designated exercise channels
- ❑ Review the escalation path:
  - ❑ Who is notified when a TTP is detected?
  - ❑ How are findings documented in real-time (exercise tracker, shared doc, ticketing system)?
  - ❑ What is the expected response if a real (non-exercise) incident occurs during the exercise?
- ❑ For remote/hybrid exercises: verify screen sharing, breakout rooms, and audio quality with all remote participants

- [ ] Confirm the exercise deconfliction process with the SOC so that exercise activity is not treated as a production incident

Owner: _____ Target Date: _____

Sign-Off

Role	Name	Date Completed	Signature
Blue Team Lead			
SOC Manager			
Hunt Team Lead			
DFIR Lead			
Exercise Coordinator			
